

ALCHEMY AOE ALLIANCE

TYPE:
HANDBOOK
(STND)



PROJECT:
N/A

STND--005

REVISION: X1

Competition, General Rules

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1 - Referenced Documents

This standard has no components.

2 - Background

This Standard was created as part of a modularization project, to “break-out” recurring text from handbooks to minimize reading for returning players.

3 - Overview

This Standard provides definition for general set of tournament rules, independent of specific settings, and could be used by any community for any type of event.

4 - Payment

4.A - Compatibility

Participants are responsible for ensuring they can receive payment through the platform selected by the tournament, from the Country of Origin.

4.B - Disbursement

Players and Creators eligible for prize winnings shall provide an address within:

- one week of the *end* of play period (for Players).
- one week of the *start* of play period (for Creators).

With a valid destination, winnings transferred within:

- two weeks of the *end* of play period (for Players).
- two weeks of the *start* of play period (for Creators).

4.C - Transaction Fees

Transaction fees to the address provided for §4.B are paid by the tournament.



5 - Accessibility

It is important for all participants to be able to find and communicate with each other. Registration will only be processed for persons in the Tournament Server.

6 - Registration Exceptions

The tournament host reserves the right to grant varying levels of exception for registrants who do not meet eligibility requirements. Such exceptions may be granted for persons who are “close” to eligibility requirements, familiar to the community, have well-understood skill level, or any combination. Exception could include privilege to play eligible or ineligible for prize winnings.

7 - Scheduling Exceptions

No exceptions or extensions will be granted to playing required sets on time.

8 - Going First

For the purposes of hosting drafts and lobbies, applying bans, etc., when applicable – the HIGHER SEED “goes first” unless otherwise specified.



9 - Lobby Settings

Table 9 summarizes the required lobby settings:

Setting	Requirement
Hidden Civilizations	Enabled
Spectator Delay	2 Minutes
Data Mod	Default
Game Mode	Random Map
Map Style	Custom
Location	[A Map From The Pool]
Map Size	Tiny (2 Player)
AI Difficulty	Standard
Resources	Standard
Population	200
Game Speed	Normal
Reveal Map	Normal
Starting Age	Standard
Ending Age	Standard
Treaty Length	<None>
Victory	Standard
Lock Teams?	Yes
Team Together?	Yes
Team Positions?	No
Shared Exploration?	No
Lock Speed?	Yes
Allow Cheats?	No
Turbo Mode?	No
Full Tech Tree?	No
Empire Wars Mode?	No
Sudden Death Mode?	No
Regicide Mode?	No
Record Game?	Yes
Antiquity Mode?	Yes

Table 9: Lobby Settings for All Tournament Games



Note from Table 9 that the new “Antiquity Mode” is *enabled*, allowing additional options from a recent game patch. Figure 9 demonstrates:

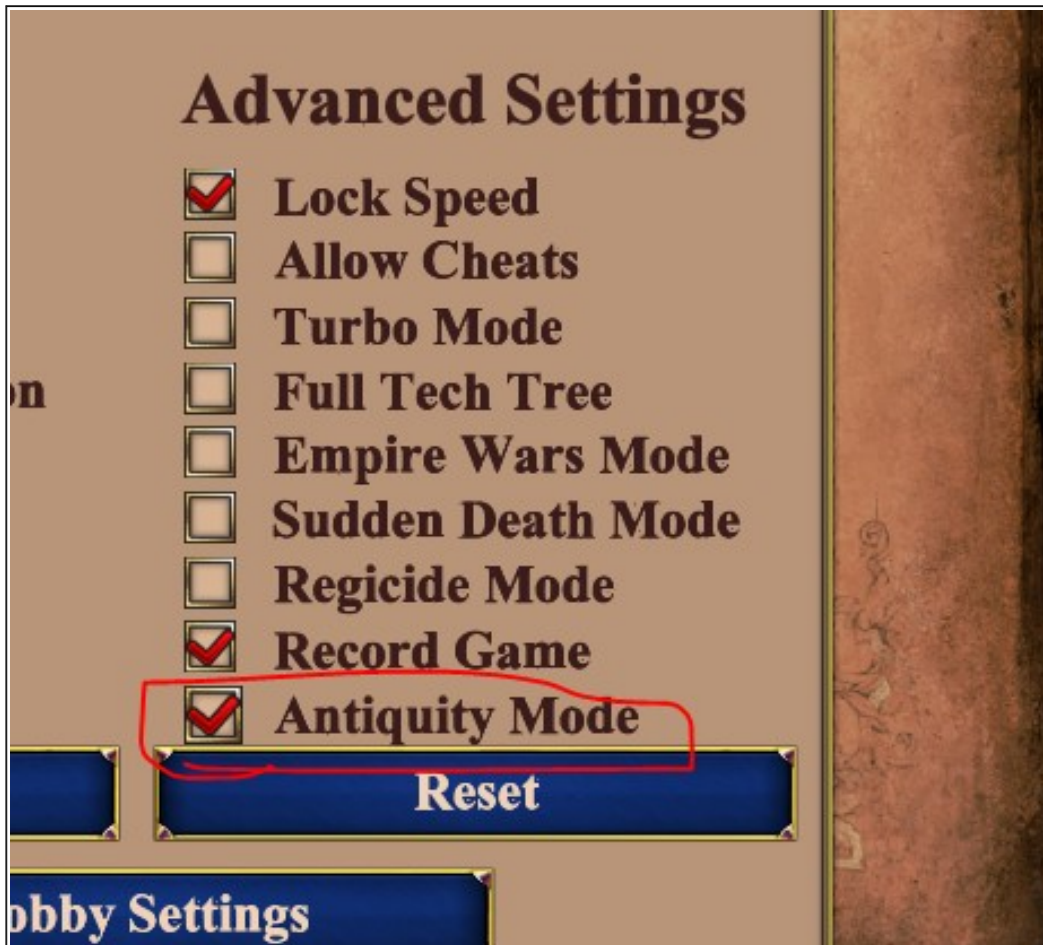


Figure 9: Enabling New Antiquity Mode

10 - Creative Strategies

Laming/Tower Rushes/Town Center Drops are all 100% allowed. Creative strategies are important to the success of the League.

11 - Nomad Unit Entrapment

On nomad maps, trapping an enemy unit against a forest or another resource using quick-walling before minute 5 is forbidden.

12 - Restarts

12.A - Map-Induced

Although rare, a map-induced restart is allowed if at least one of the following are true.

- Resources are missing, inaccessible, or at least 50% of their surface area is blocked by terrain or another resource.
- Starting player-controlled units are missing or trapped by terrain or resources.

12.B - Wrong Civ Picked

If a player accidentally selects a forbidden civilization after the game is launched (thus having seen the opponent's civilization), then the game is restarted with that opponent selecting a civilization for the mistaken player from their available draft.

13 - Cheating

Cheating is forbidden. The following are considered cheating:

- Bug exploits.
- Receipt of information from anyone who is not an opponent or tournament administrator during a league game.
- Failure to disclose all relevant alternate/"smurf" accounts during registration, thereby attempting to mislead the tournament elo calculation.

14 - Performance Tracking

Participants give consent for their performance to be publicly shared and viewable by anyone, including competitors.

15 - Recording Availability

After playing in each round, recordings proving the outcome shall be uploaded to the appropriate channel in the Tournament Server before the start of the next round. Such an upload is ultimately the responsibility of whoever won the set, but the community appreciates being unable to predict the winner based on who posted the results.

The following information shall also be included:

- Round Number
- @Player names
- Match Result (Use spoiler tag, sandwich between players)
- Names of maps that were played
- Game Recording Files

A spoiler tag may be attached through use of two vertical bars at the start and end of the message:

|| this is a spoiler message ||

For example, if TechChariot were wiped out by SmurfChariot in Round 4, then the results could be posted by either player as follows:

Round 4 @TechChariot || 0 - 2 || @SmurfChariot – Map1, Map2

TechChariot_vs_SmurfChariot_G1.aoe2record

TechChariot_vs_SmurfChariot_G2.aoe2record



16 - Behavioral Code of Conduct

Server rules apply to all tournament activities, including direct messaging and in-game chat.

17 - Cosmopolitan Community

The community does not exclude people on the basis of protected class or unpopular beliefs/associations. Its events are designed to unify Age of Empires II players, creators, and viewers around love of the game. Anyone is welcome to participate, as long as they:

- Make a credible pledge to meet the requirements of the handbook.
- Provide an honest estimation of their skill, such that selection of worthy opponents may be done with confidence.



Signatures:

TechChariot

2025-03-29

Prepared

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Sample

2025-MM-DD

Checked

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Sample

2025-MM-DD

Approved

*Date (YYYY-MM-DD)*Sample

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X1	-- Advanced Release for Community Review --	N/A	2025-04-28

